

ASSERTIVE INDIA

In a world changing rapidly around it, India remained an island of relative political and economic calm, anchored by the stability and decisiveness of the Narendra Modi regime. As he and his party grew stronger, so did their capability to take and execute hard decisions. From scrapping Article 370 in Kashmir and launching strikes on Pakistan for its acts of terror on Indian soil, to braving Donald Trump's punitive 50 per cent trade tariffs, India stood firm. At home, it went after the Maoists, determined to neutralise India's biggest internal security threat.

Modi brought the same resoluteness to the economy, most sensationally—and controversially—with the attempt to curb black money through demonetisation. The Goods and Services Tax was another landmark reform, ambitious in its intent to overhaul India's indirect tax structure even if its execution fell short of expectations.

All this while relentlessly advancing the larger Hindutva cause. Ayodhya finally got a Ram temple, ending a century-old dispute with trimuphalist assertion.